was held at the grand viceregal palace the British had built for their summer capital, with the silver crown of Himalayan ice-tops to its north. Bhutto's oldest Indian school chum, Piloo Mody, had flown in with the Indian delegation. "Bhutto . . . is above all a realist," Piloo wrote, "a great bluffer when he holds a poor hand, but always ready to arrive at mutually acceptable solutions if his opponent is big enough or shrewd enough not to push him into a corner."[1] Indira Gandhi was both. Precious little was agreed upon during the first three days, but on the fourth and last evening, after the presidents' dinner, they went off alone to agree upon the final details of their peace agreement, which they signed on 2 July 1972.

Bhutto and Gandhi agreed to "settle their differences by peaceful means through bilateral negotiations" in the future, and the UN cease-fire line in Kashmir was renamed the "Line of Control."[2] Indira would have accepted that Line of Control as Kashmir's international border if Pakistan had agreed. No mention was made of any future plebiscite in Kashmir, however, and Bhutto's opponents in Lahore denounced him for having sold out Pakistan's future claims to all of the Vale. Bhutto solemnly swore that he had promised Indira "nothing" as to the future of Kashmir, but, as Piloo noted, Bhutto was both a realist and a great bluffer. After the Simla meeting, India returned more than 5,000 square miles of Pakistani desert captured during the 1971 war, and soon agreed to allow Pakistan to have its 93,000 Bihari prisoners back, though no government in Islamabad has ever been eager to make room for so many Biharis, still unwanted by both countries.

Pakistan remained much diminished and poorer, but Bhutto now had the time he needed to forge ahead in rebuilding its power, diplomatically as well as technologically. The Simla summit restored his self-confidence and enhanced Pakistan's international stature. So Bhutto focused on what he called his nation's need to "unleash a great force," encouraging Pakistan's physicists and engineers to learn as much as possible about nuclear weapons and to buy, or steal whatever they could not purchase, from the West. Dr. A. Q. Khan was the most notorious of those Pakistani nuclear procurers, stealing plans of "the secret uranium enrichment process" by "ultracentrifugation," developed in Amsterdam's Physical Dynamics Research Laboratory, where he was employed in 1973.[3] Dr. Khan flew home with his stolen keys to the swift enrichment of uranium in December 1974, taking charge of Pakistan's Kahuta Atomic Energy Laboratory. Bhutto himself arranged to import uranium